

Math 299 Exercises

Lance Remigio

October 6, 2025

Contents

1	Week 1	1
1.1	Zorn's Lemma	1
1.2	Hahn-Banach Theorem	1
2	Week 7: Reflexive Spaces	3

1 Week 1

1.1 Zorn's Lemma

Problem 1 (4.1.2). Let X be the set of all real-valued functions on X on the interval $[0, 1]$, and let $x \leq y$ to mean that $x(t) \leq y(t)$ for all $t \in [0, 1]$. Show that this defines a partial ordering. Is it total ordering? Does X have a maximal elements?

Proof. Define $F = \{\text{all real-valued functions on the interval } [0, 1]\}$. First, we show reflexivity. Let $x \in F$. Then for all $t \in [0, 1]$, $x(t) \leq x(t)$. Hence, $x \leq x$ and so F contains the reflexive property. For antisymmetry, suppose $x \leq y$ and $y \leq x$. Then for all $t \in [0, 1]$, we have $x(t) \leq y(t)$ and $y(t) \leq x(t)$. Then $x(t) = y(t)$ (using the partial ordering of the real numbers) for all $t \in [0, 1]$. Then $x = y$ and so antisymmetry is satisfied. For transitivity, suppose $x \leq y$ and $y \leq z$. Then $x(t) \leq y(t)$ and $y(t) \leq z(t)$ for all $t \in [0, 1]$. Then $x(t) \leq z(t)$ for all $t \in [0, 1]$ using the transitivity of the real numbers. Hence, $x \leq z$ and so transitivity is satisfied.

F is totally ordered, but has no maximal elements. ■

Problem 2 (4.1.5). Prove that a finite partially ordered set A has at least one maximal element.

Proof. ■

1.2 Hahn-Banach Theorem

Problem 3 (Existence of a Sublinear Functional). Show that a sublinear functional p satisfies $p(0) = 0$ and $p(-x) \geq -p(x)$.

Proof. Define $P : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$p(x) = \|x\|$$

where X is some vector space. Then for $x = 0$, we have

$$p(0) = \|0\| = 0.$$

Note that for all $x \in X$, we have

$$p(-x) = \|-x\| = |-1|\|x\| = 1 \cdot \|x\| = \|x\| > 0$$

and $p(-x) = p(x)$. Now, note that for all $x \in X$

$$-\|x\| \leq \|x\| \iff -p(x) \leq p(x) = p(-x).$$

Thus, for all $x \in X$, $p(-x) \geq -p(x)$. ■

Problem 4 (Convex Set). If p is a sublinear functional on a vector space X , show that $M = \{x : p(x) \leq \gamma, \gamma > 0 \text{ fixed}\}$, is a convex set.

Proof. Assume that p is a sublinear functional on a vector space X . Let $W = \{v = \alpha y + (1 - \alpha)z : 0 \leq \alpha \leq 1\}$. Our goal is to show that $W \subseteq M$. To this end, let $v \in W$ be arbitrary. Then for some $y, z \in M$, we have $v = \alpha y + (1 - \alpha)z$ where $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$. Since $y, z \in M$, we have $p(y) \leq \gamma$ and $p(z) \leq \gamma$ where $\gamma > 0$ is fixed. Our goal is to show that $p(v) \leq \gamma$ for fixed γ . Using the sublinearity of p , we get that

$$\begin{aligned} p(v) &= p(\alpha y + (1 - \alpha)z) \\ &\leq p(\alpha y) + p((1 - \alpha)z) \\ &= |\alpha|p(y) + |(1 - \alpha)|p(z) \\ &= \alpha p(y) + (1 - \alpha)p(z) & (0 \leq \alpha \leq 1) \\ &\leq \alpha\gamma + (1 - \alpha)\gamma \\ &= \gamma. \end{aligned}$$

Hence, we conclude that $W \subseteq M$ since v was an arbitrary element and so M is a convex set. ■

Problem 5. Let p be a sublinear functional on a real vector space X . Let f be defined on $Z = \{x \in X : x = \alpha x_0, \alpha \in \mathbb{R}\}$ by $f(x) = \alpha p(x_0)$ with fixed $x_0 \in X$. Show that f is a linear functional on Z satisfying $f(x) \leq p(x)$.

Proof. First, we will show that f is a linear functional on Z . Let $u, v \in Z$. Then $u = \alpha_1 x_0$ and $v = \alpha_2 x_0$ for $\alpha_1, \alpha_2 \in \mathbb{R}$. Let $\delta \in \mathbb{R}$. Observe that

$$f(x) = \alpha p(x_0) = p(\alpha x_0).$$

Using this observation, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \delta f(u) + f(v) &= \delta \alpha_1 p(x_0) + \alpha_2 p(x_0) \\ &= (\delta \alpha_1 + \alpha_2) p(x_0) \\ &= p(\delta \alpha_1 x_0 + \alpha_2 x_0) \\ &= p(\delta u + v) \\ &= f(\delta u + v). \end{aligned}$$

Hence, f is a linear functional. Using our observation again, we can also see that for $\alpha > 0$, $f(x) = p(x)$ and so $f(x) \leq p(x)$ for all $x \in Z$. Clearly, the inequality holds if $\alpha = 0$. Now, suppose $\alpha < 0$. Then

$$f(x) = \alpha p(x_0) = |\alpha|p(x_0) = p(|\alpha|x_0) = p(x)$$

and so $f(x) \leq p(x)$ for all $x \in Z$. ■

Problem 6. If p is a sublinear on a real vector space X , show that there exists a linear functional $\tilde{f}$ on X such that

$$-p(-x) \leq \tilde{f}(x) \leq p(x).$$

Proof. Define Z as in the set in the previous problem and define $f(x) = \alpha p(x_0)$ with fixed $x_0 \in X$. Using the same problem, we proved that f defines linear functional such that $f(x) \leq p(x)$ for all $x \in Z$. Since $Z \subseteq X$, we can find an extension (via the Hahn-Banach Theorem) $\tilde{f}$ that is also a linear functional from

Z to X satisfying $\tilde{f}(x) \leq p(x)$ for all $x \in X$. All we need to show now is $-p(-x) \leq \tilde{f}(x)$. Since the bound in the previous statement holds for all $x \in X$, we have

$$-\tilde{f}(x) = \tilde{f}(-x) \leq p(-x).$$

Multiplying through by a negative, we now have

$$\tilde{f}(x) \geq -p(-x)$$

which completes our proof. ■

2 Week 7: Reflexive Spaces

Theorem (Dual Space (2.10-4)). The dual space X' of a normed space X is a Banach Space (whether or not X is).

Proposition. The dual space of $\mathbb{R}^n$ is $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Recall the definition of Algebraic Reflexivity of a vector space X that was introduced in section 2.8.

Definition (Algebraic Reflexivity). A vector space X is said to be **algebraic reflexive** if the canonical mapping $C : X \rightarrow X^{**}$ is surjective.

- Here we see that X^{**} is the second algebraic dual space of X and the mapping C is defined by $x \mapsto g_x$ where

$$g_x(f) = f(x). \quad ; \quad ((1) \ (f \in X^*))$$

that is, for any $x \in X$ the image is the linear functional g_x defined by the above.

- If X is finite-dimensional, then X is algebraic reflexive.

Consider a normed space X and its dual space X' (the space of all bounded linear functionals). Observe that $(X')'$ is the **second dual space** of X (or **bidual space** of X). We define a similar mapping to the above statement, by setting

$$g_x(f) = f(x) \quad . \quad ((2), \ (f \in X'))$$

The only difference here is that f is now bounded and so g_x is bounded.

Lemma (Norm of g_x). For every fixed x in a normed space X , the functional g_x defined above is a bounded linear functional on X' , so that $g_x \in X''$, and has the norm

$$\|g_x\| = \|x\|. \quad (3)$$

Proof. It is easy to see that g_x is linear, and (3) follows from (2) and corollary 4.3-4; that is,

$$\|g_x\| = \sup_{\substack{f \in X' \\ f \neq 0}} \frac{|g_x(f)|}{\|f\|} = \sup_{\substack{f \in X' \\ f \neq 0}} \frac{|f(x)|}{\|f\|} = \|x\|. \quad (4)$$

- This lemma tells us that for every $x \in X$, there corresponds a unique bounded linear functional $g_x \in X''$ given by (2) which defines the **canonical mapping** of X into X'' :

$$\begin{aligned} C : X &\longrightarrow X'' \\ x &\longmapsto g_x \end{aligned} \quad (5)$$

- This map is linear and injective and preserves the norm; that is, in terms of mapping the domain to its range, it will be an isomorphism of normed spaces.

Lemma (Canonical Mapping). The canonical mapping C given by (5) is an isomorphism of the normed space X onto the normed space $\mathcal{R}(C)$, the range of C .

Proof. We can easily see the linearity of C . Indeed, we have

$$g_{\alpha x + \beta y}(f) = f(\alpha x + \beta y) = \alpha f(x) + \beta f(y) = \alpha g_x(f) + \beta g_y(f).$$

In particular, we have $g_x - g_y = g_{x-y}$. Thus, we obtain

$$\|g_x - g_y\| = \|g_{x-y}\| = \|x - y\|.$$

This tells us that C is an isometry and so it must preserve the norm. Because isometries are injective, C is also injective. This can be directly seen from the above formula. Indeed, for any $x \neq y$, we have $g_x \neq g_y$ by axiom (N2) in section 2.2. Since we are considering maps from X to the range of C , it follows that C is also surjective. Thus, C must be bijective. ■

Definition (Embeddable). We say that a set X is **embeddable** in a normed space Z if X is isomorphic with a subspace of Z .

- From our Canonical Mapping Lemma, we can see that X is embeddable in X'' since the range of C is a subspace of X'' and it is isomorphic to X .
- The mapping C is called the **canonical embedding** in this case.
- In general, the range of C will be a proper subspace of X'' .
- If the range of C happens to be a surjection, then we will call it a different name which will be defined below.

Definition (Reflexivity). A normed space X is said to be **reflexive** if

$$\mathcal{R}(C) = X''$$

where $C : X \rightarrow X''$ is the canonical mapping given by (5) and (2).

- If X is reflexive, it is isomorphic (and hence isometric) with X'' by Lemma 4.6-2.
- However, the converse does not hold.
- Completeness does not necessarily imply reflexivity.
- However, the converse does hold which will be outlined below.

Theorem (Completeness). If a normed space X is reflexive, it is complete (hence a Banach space).

Proof. Since X'' is the dual space of X' , it is complete by Theorem 2.10-4. Reflexivity of X means that $\mathcal{R}(C) = X''$. Completeness of X now follows from that of X'' by Lemma 4.6-2. ■

- An example of a reflexive space is $\mathbb{R}^n$ which follows from example 2.10-5.
- For finite dimensions, every linear functional on a general normed space X is bounded and so $X' = X^*$ which implies further that

Theorem (Finite Dimension). Every finite-dimensional normed space is reflexive.

- l^p with $1 < p < +\infty$ is reflexive.
- $L^p[a, b]$ with $1 < p < +\infty$ is reflexive.
- Non-examples are $C[a, b]$, l^1 , $L^1[a, b]$, l^∞ and the subspaces c and c_0 of l^∞ where c is the space of all convergent sequence of scalars and c_0 is the space of all sequences of scalars converging to zero.